whisperstream

WHISPERSTREAM / 2.0.0

Your complete offline guide.

Set up dictation, make it your own,
and keep your models available.

Everything in this guide is saved with the app.
No website connection is needed to read it.

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Install and configure Whisperstream

Install Whisperstream on Windows or Mac, complete first-run setup, and make your first dictation.

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Install Whisperstream

Whisperstream supports Windows 10 and Windows 11 on x64 computers. A Mac version is available as a beta for Macs with Apple silicon running macOS 14 Sonoma or later. Download the free official installer from **Whisperstream**.

Windows

1. Download and open the Whisperstream installer.
2. Review the license agreement and select **I Agree** to continue.
3. Choose whether to install for your Windows account or make the app available across Windows accounts.
4. Approve elevation if you selected an all-users installation.
5. Launch Whisperstream when setup finishes.

Choose **Install just for me** for your Windows account. Choose **Install for anyone using this computer** to make the app available to other Windows accounts when you can approve the administrator prompt. Each user still accepts the EULA.

If you are switching from an earlier installation, back up your data and keep its installer before installing the open-source edition. The switch requires running the new installer yourself.

Mac (beta)

1. Download and open the Whisperstream disk image (DMG).
2. Drag Whisperstream to your Applications folder.
3. Open Whisperstream from Applications.
4. Review the license agreement and select **I agree** to continue.

The official Mac installer requires Apple Silicon. Intel Macs can use the experimental **source build** for dictation and Agent Speak, with Python 3.12 or 3.13. Managed local AI cleanup is unavailable in the Intel source build.

Build and run from source

Start with the **source README** for requirements, exact dependencies and the contributor launcher. Run the native Tauri shell for dictation into other applications. Browser mode is for UI development and does not prove native text insertion or window behavior. The source uses the public sherpa-onnx and sherpa-onnx-core 1.13.8 packages. No private package archive or official signing credentials are required.

The launcher keeps source development data separate from existing installations. Follow the selected revision's setup and update instructions.

Complete first-run setup

On first launch, Whisperstream asks you to accept the EULA before the main setup opens. The guided setup then helps you:

1. Choose a dictation language.
2. On a Mac, allow Microphone and Accessibility access. See **Allow access on a Mac**.
3. Confirm or change the Push to Talk shortcut while the matching speech model downloads in the background.
4. Try dictation in the setup text box after the model is ready.
5. Optionally, turn on AI enhancement with Stream-1 Mini, Whisperstream's on-device cleanup model.

Follow the progress shown in setup. Dictation becomes available when the model is ready.

The enhancement step is optional. Choose **Skip & finish** to leave enhancement off and download nothing. Choose **Turn on enhancement** to download Stream-1 Mini (about 460 MB) and check how fast it runs on this computer:

- If it runs well, local enhancement turns on and you can try two examples before finishing.
- If it runs slowly, choose **Use it anyway** or **Leave enhancement off**.
- If it is too slow, enhancement stays off.

You can change this later in **Enhancement**; see **Enhancement providers**. To prepare an offline installation or restore model files manually, see **Install and recover models offline**.

Allow access on a Mac

Whisperstream needs two macOS permissions:

PERMISSION	WHY IT IS NEEDED
Microphone	Records your voice for dictation.
Accessibility	Lets your shortcut work in other apps and types text into them.

In setup, select **Allow microphone** and **Allow accessibility**, then respond to the macOS prompts. If access was denied earlier, select **Open System Settings**, go to **Privacy & Security**, open **Microphone** or **Accessibility**, turn on Whisperstream, then return and select **Check again**. If Accessibility is on but Whisperstream still asks for it, select **Restart app**.

Without Accessibility, your shortcuts and text insertion do not work. To check access later, open **Home** and find **Permissions**.

Make your first dictation

The default Push to Talk shortcut is Right Shift.

1. Use the test step in setup, or finish setup and click a text field in another app.
2. Hold your Push to Talk shortcut (Right Shift if you did not change it).
3. Speak one short sentence in the language you selected.
4. Release the shortcut to stop recording.
5. Wait for Whisperstream to transcribe the sentence. The text appears in the setup box or the selected app.

If the setup test works, installation is complete.

Choose your next guide

- Change recording shortcuts or reuse the last dictation: **Recording controls**
- Change language or review speech models: **Languages and models**
- Choose a microphone or adjust recording sounds: **Audio**
- Fix delivery in a particular application: **Text insertion**
- Learn how updates and uninstall work: **App basics**

Use the documentation navigation for every other feature.

App basics and updates

Use the tray app, save offline documentation, and preserve your data when uninstalling.

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Keep Whisperstream available

Whisperstream stays available from the Windows notification area, or the menu bar on a Mac, while you work. Closing the main window hides it instead of ending the app, so your dictation shortcuts continue to work.

ACTION	RESULT
Close the Whisperstream window	Hides the window and keeps Whisperstream running.
Select the Whisperstream tray icon	Opens the window, or brings it to the front.
Select **Quit** from the tray menu	Stops Whisperstream and its dictation shortcuts.

After selecting **Quit**, use the Start menu or desktop shortcut to start an installed app again. For a source checkout, restart its launcher.

On a Mac, the Whisperstream icon is in the menu bar. Click it to open the window, or open its menu for **Settings** and **Quit**. The Dock icon appears only while a Whisperstream window is open. To start Whisperstream again after quitting, open it from Applications.

Turn on **Home > Run on Startup** to start Whisperstream in the background when you sign in. On a Mac, macOS may ask you to approve Whisperstream in System Settings before startup is enabled. On the same page, choose **Light** or **Dark** to change Whisperstream's appearance.

Included features and updates

All features are included free. No license key or activation server is required.

How you update depends on how you installed Whisperstream:

- **Official installer (Windows and Mac):** Whisperstream checks for a signed update at most about once a day, and when you select **Check for updates** in **About**. When an update is available, select **Update now** to download and install it. Nothing is downloaded or installed until you accept, and Whisperstream verifies the update's signature first. Lockdown Mode stops update checks.
- **Built from source:** Whisperstream makes no update checks or downloads. To update, get newer source from the **source repository** and follow its README to rebuild. **About > Source code** opens the repository.

To switch from the older commercial edition, run the open-source installer.

Updates and responses to reports are provided as available; no schedule or guaranteed support is promised.

Keep your installer, or your source revision and its build instructions, and a backup of the models you use. See **Install and recover models offline**.

Get help or report a bug

Open **About** to use these actions:

- **Report a bug** opens a public bug-report form on GitHub.
- **Request a feature** opens a public feature-request form on GitHub.
- **Read documentation** opens the online guide.
- **Source code** opens the Whisperstream repository on GitHub.

GitHub issues are public. Do not include transcripts, recordings, API keys, or personal information. For private support or security reports, email **support@whisperstream.io**.

No report is submitted by opening a link. Export logs locally and review them before attaching. Attaching a file uploads it to GitHub immediately, before submitting the issue. Nothing is uploaded automatically.

External support links and update checks are unavailable in Lockdown Mode. Local documentation, legal documents, and log exports remain available.

Save the documentation

Open **About** and select **Save documentation**. Choose a folder in the folder picker. Whisperstream saves a PDF of the complete guide and an unpacked Markdown folder for search and AI tools. Both formats are bundled with the app and work without the website.

When **Documentation saved** appears, select **Open folder** to find the files. Cancelling the folder picker does not save anything. Repeated saves use a separate folder so existing files are preserved.

For local diagnostic information, see **Export logs**.

Uninstall Whisperstream or remove a source checkout

For a source development checkout, stop its launcher before removing the checkout. Keep or remove its isolated data separately; see the source README.

For an installed app, on Windows 11 open **Settings > Apps > Installed apps**. On Windows 10, open **Settings > Apps > Apps & features**. Find Whisperstream and select **Uninstall**.

The uninstaller asks whether to remove Whisperstream's local data with the app. Review **what survives uninstall** before choosing.

On a Mac, select **Quit** from the menu bar icon, then move Whisperstream from Applications to the Trash. This leaves your settings, history, and models in place; see **what survives uninstall** to remove them.

Recording controls and last-transcript actions

Configure Push to Talk, Toggle, the recording indicator, and shortcuts that reuse the most recent dictation.

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Choose how recording starts and stops

Whisperstream gives **Push to Talk** and **Toggle** separate global shortcuts. You can assign either one or use both, then choose the gesture that suits each dictation. The shortcuts work while Whisperstream is running, even when its main window is not focused.

CONTROL	HOW IT WORKS	NEW-INSTALL DEFAULT
Push to Talk	Hold the shortcut to record, then release it to stop.	Right Shift
Toggle	Press once to start recording, then press again to stop.	Not set

Push to Talk works well for short dictations and precise start and stop control. Toggle is useful for longer dictations when you do not want to hold a key.

On a Mac, shortcuts use the same keys and appear with macOS symbols. Ctrl is Control (^) and Alt is Option (⌥), so Ctrl+Alt+V appears as ^⌥V. Shortcuts need Accessibility access; see **Allow access on a Mac**.

Assign or clear a shortcut

Open **Controls**, then find **Hotkeys**.

1. Select the shortcut field beside **Push to Talk** or **Toggle**.
2. Press the key or key combination you want.
3. Release all keys to save it.

While the field is listening, press Escape to cancel without changing the saved shortcut. To clear a shortcut, select its field and use the × control that appears.

Whisperstream warns about shortcuts that may conflict with the operating system or another Whisperstream action, but it does not block them. If the system or another app responds instead, choose a different combination. When both recording shortcuts are cleared, Controls shows **No recording shortcut is set. Set Push to Talk or Toggle to start dictating.**

Start a dictation

- With **Push to Talk**, place the text cursor in the destination, hold the shortcut, wait for the start chime to finish or the indicator to appear, speak, then release it.
- With **Toggle**, place the text cursor in the destination, press the shortcut, wait for the start chime to finish or the indicator to appear, speak, then press it again.
- With the desktop control, select **Start dictation**, speak, then select the checkmark (**Finish and type**).

After you stop recording, Whisperstream processes and inserts the final text.

Discard a recording

- During a Push to Talk or Toggle recording, press Escape.
- During a recording started from the desktop control, select the × (**Cancel dictation**).

Discarding stops the recording without transcribing, inserting, or saving it. Escape does not control a recording started from the desktop control.

Keep the indicator or recording control visible

The recording indicator is on for new installations. To hide or restore it, open **Controls**, find **Recording Indicator**, and turn **Show indicator** off or on. The indicator shows when Whisperstream is recording and when it is processing the result. Whisperstream hides it while a screen reader is active, even when **Show indicator** is on.

To leave a compact recording control on the desktop between dictations, turn on **Keep control visible** in the same section. This setting is off by default and requires **Show indicator**. Point to the compact control to reveal **Start dictation**, then select it.

For provisional words inside the indicator, see **Live Preview**.

Reuse the most recent dictation

Assign these actions under **Controls > Hotkeys**, then place the cursor where you want the text and press the shortcut.

ACTION	WHAT IT INSERTS	NEW-INSTALL DEFAULT
Paste Last Transcript	The most recent final transcript, including AI enhancement when it ran.	Ctrl+Alt+V
Paste Last Transcript (Original)	The same dictation before AI enhancement, after normal Dictionary and text-processing rules.	Not set

These actions are available only after a dictation finishes and while Whisperstream remains running. Restarting the app clears both remembered values. For a lasting record, use **Transcript and audio history**.

For delivery settings and application compatibility, see **Text insertion and compatibility**.

Languages and speech recognition models

Choose a dictation language, compare supported speech models, and follow multilingual recording guidance.

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Choose a dictation language

Open **Home**, select **Dictation Language**, and choose the language you plan to speak. Whisperstream uses Automatic selection by default: it chooses the recommended speech-recognition model and, if needed, asks before downloading it. Wait for the download to finish before dictating.

The model currently in use appears under **Voice Recognition Model**. Automatic selection uses:

- NVIDIA Parakeet v2 for English.
- NVIDIA Parakeet v3 for supported non-English languages.
- Qwen3 ASR when Parakeet does not support the selected language.

If your current model also supports a new language, Whisperstream may ask whether to keep it or switch to the recommendation. Keeping it turns on Manual selection. If a manually selected model does not support the new language, Whisperstream returns to Automatic and offers the compatible recommendation.

> Important: Keep each recording to one language. Parakeet and Qwen3 ASR normally detect the language for each recording. Cohere Transcribe always uses your selected Dictation Language. Changing languages mid-recording can reduce accuracy.

Compare speech-recognition models

MODEL	USED FOR	LANGUAGES	APPROXIMATE DOWNLOAD
NVIDIA Parakeet v2	Default English recognition	English	661 MB
NVIDIA Parakeet v3	Default recognition for supported non-English languages	25 languages	670 MB
Qwen3 ASR	Recognition for languages outside Parakeet's range	30 languages	987 MB
Cohere Transcribe	Optional Manual selection	14 languages	2.9 GB

After the selected model is downloaded, speech recognition runs on your computer without an internet connection. Selecting a language or model that needs another download opens a confirmation first.

These models produce the raw transcript. For optional cleanup after recognition, see **Enhancement providers**.

Choose a model manually

Automatic is recommended for most users. To choose a compatible model yourself:

1. On **Home**, open the model picker when alternatives are available.
2. Choose a compatible model. Choosing one enters Manual selection.
3. Open **Advanced** and turn on **Choose speech model manually** to reveal additional compatible choices.

The picker appears when more than one model supports the selected language. Cohere Transcribe is available only through Manual selection and requires more memory than the other choices. Choosing Parakeet automatically uses its English or multilingual version as appropriate.

On an Apple Silicon Mac, Parakeet v3 runs on an engine built for Apple silicon and downloads in a different format, so its download size differs from the table above. Parakeet v2, Qwen3 ASR, and Cohere Transcribe use the same model files on Windows and Mac. Experimental Intel Mac source builds also use the Windows-compatible ONNX files for Parakeet v3, running on CPU. Turn off **Choose speech model manually** to return to the recommended model for your language.

Whisperstream keeps downloaded models when you switch, so switching back does not require another download. To remove one, open the model picker and use **Delete** beside a downloaded model that is not in use. To remove every unused speech-recognition model, open **Advanced** and select **Delete unused models** under **Model storage location**. A deleted model can be downloaded again later.

Supported languages

Whisperstream offers 39 dictation languages. **Default model** shows what Automatic selection recommends. Where multiple models are listed, Manual selection lets you choose among them. Cohere Transcribe is never selected automatically.

LANGUAGE	SUPPORTED MODELS	DEFAULT MODEL
Arabic	Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Qwen3 ASR
Bulgarian	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Cantonese	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Chinese	Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Qwen3 ASR
Croatian	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Czech	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR	Parakeet v3
Danish	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR	Parakeet v3
Dutch	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3
English	Parakeet v2, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v2
Estonian	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Filipino	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Finnish	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR	Parakeet v3
French	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3
German	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3
Greek	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3
Hindi	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Hungarian	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR	Parakeet v3
Indonesian	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Italian	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3

LANGUAGE	SUPPORTED MODELS	DEFAULT MODEL
Japanese	Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Qwen3 ASR
Korean	Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Qwen3 ASR
Latvian	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Lithuanian	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Macedonian	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Malay	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Maltese	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Persian	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Polish	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3
Portuguese	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3
Romanian	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR	Parakeet v3
Russian	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR	Parakeet v3
Slovak	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Slovenian	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Spanish	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Parakeet v3
Swedish	Parakeet v3, Qwen3 ASR	Parakeet v3
Thai	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Turkish	Qwen3 ASR	Qwen3 ASR
Ukrainian	Parakeet v3	Parakeet v3
Vietnamese	Qwen3 ASR, Cohere Transcribe	Qwen3 ASR

If recognition chooses the wrong language

1. Confirm that **Dictation Language** matches the language you are speaking.
2. Use one language for the entire recording.

3. If Qwen3 ASR repeatedly detects the wrong language, turn on **Choose speech model manually**, select Qwen3 ASR, then turn on **Force selected language**.

Force selected language appears only when Qwen3 ASR is manually selected. It tells Qwen which language to listen for instead of detecting it. Returning to Automatic or choosing another model clears this setting. Cohere Transcribe already uses your selected language and does not show this control. If its output is in the wrong language, check **Dictation Language** before recording again.

Microphone, playback, and system audio

Choose a microphone, configure recording chimes, and control whether Whisperstream leaves, lowers, or mutes other audio while recording.

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Choose a microphone

Open **Audio** to choose the input device Whisperstream records and to control what you hear during a recording.

INPUT CHOICE	BEHAVIOR
Use system default	Follows the microphone currently selected as the system default input. This is the new-install default.
Named microphone	Keeps Whisperstream on that device while it is available. If it cannot be found or opened, Whisperstream uses the system default input.

Selecting a microphone in Whisperstream does not change the system default for other apps. Choose **Use system default** if you regularly switch headsets. Choose a named microphone when you want Whisperstream to keep using one device.

To confirm the selection, make a short recording and review the completed transcript. If the result is empty or unclear, check that the intended microphone is connected and working in Windows, then try another input.

If no inputs appear, allow microphone access for desktop apps in Windows privacy settings and reconnect the device. Then select **Quit** from the Whisperstream tray menu and start Whisperstream again. On a Mac, check **Home > Permissions**, or turn on Whisperstream in **System Settings > Privacy & Security > Microphone**.

Choose where audio plays

Recording chimes use the Windows default output that was active when chime playback started, normally when Whisperstream launched. To use another speaker or headset, change the Windows default output. If the chimes continue playing through the previous device, select **Quit** from the Whisperstream tray menu and start Whisperstream again.

Input and output are separate. Selecting a microphone in Whisperstream does not select where chimes or other Windows audio play.

Spoken Agent Speak responses from Codex and Claude Code check the current Windows default output before each response. For voice, speed, and volume controls, see **Agent Speak**.

Configure recording chimes

Recording Chime plays one sound when recording starts and another when it stops. It is on by default and helps confirm the recording boundary when the Whisperstream window is hidden.

Use **Chime Volume** to set the chimes from 0 to 100 percent. The starting value is 100 percent. Your Windows output volume also affects what you hear. Turn **Recording Chime** off when audible cues would be disruptive.

Control other audio while recording

Use **Audio While Recording** to choose what happens to other Windows playback during a dictation.

SETTING	DURING RECORDING
None	Leaves other audio unchanged. This is the new-install default.
Lower	Reduces the active Windows output to 20 percent of its previous level.
Mute	Mutes the active Windows output.

Whisperstream restores the previous volume and mute state when recording ends. On a Mac, **Lower** and **Mute** are available only when the current output device supports volume control. Choose **Lower** when you still need to hear a call or media. Choose **Mute** when playback should be silent for the entire recording.

Test **Lower** or **Mute** with the headset and calling software you plan to use. If other audio remains quiet after recording, restore the Windows volume or mute state manually. If the problem repeats, leave **Audio While Recording** set to **None** and review **Settings and data locations** for local diagnostics.

Live Preview

Understand provisional text in the recording display and how it differs from the final transcript.

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See words while you speak

Live Preview shows provisional speech recognition inside the recording indicator while you dictate. It can help you confirm that Whisperstream is following your speech and make longer recordings easier to track.

The preview is display only. It never inserts partial text into the active app, and it is not the final transcript.

Turn on Live Preview

1. Open **Controls**.
2. Under **Recording Indicator**, turn on **Show indicator**.
3. Turn on **Live Preview**.
4. Start a recording and speak normally.

Live Preview is off by default. Its setting depends on **Show indicator**, because the preview appears inside that indicator.

Read the preview

Words appear after Whisperstream has received enough speech to form a useful result. The preview is provisional, so unconfirmed words may be corrected, shortened, or replaced as you continue speaking.

Wait for the completed text in your target app before checking important names, numbers, or exact wording. The final transcript is produced separately after recording stops and may differ from the last preview you saw.

Very short recordings may finish before a useful preview appears. This does not necessarily mean the recording failed.

Expand or collapse the preview

The compact recording indicator keeps the preview small while you work. Use the pointer control labeled **Expand preview** to open a larger, centered reading surface with the complete current preview. Use **Collapse preview** to return to the compact view.

The expanded view remains open while the current recording is processed. A new recording starts in the compact view.

What happens when recording stops

When you stop recording, Whisperstream freezes the last preview and shows a spinner while it prepares the completed result. The recording indicator closes after processing finishes.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
Live Preview	Provisional, display-only words that can change while you speak
Completed text in your target app	The separately produced final transcript used after recording

Live Preview does not control the completed result. Configure that in **Enhancement providers**, **Dictionary**, or **Text insertion**.

If the preview does not appear

- Confirm that both **Show indicator** and **Live Preview** are on.
- Try a recording with a complete sentence. A very short recording may end before preview text appears.
- If Whisperstream detects a screen reader, it hides the visual recording indicator and Live Preview because changing provisional words are not announced. This does not change the completed dictation. See **Text insertion** for output compatibility options.

For microphone selection and input troubleshooting, see **Audio**.

Text insertion and compatibility

Choose clipboard or keystroke insertion and test applications with accessibility or remote-session constraints.

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Choose an input style

Open **Controls** and choose an **Input Style**. Start with Clipboard for standard apps and terminals. Choose Keystroke for screen readers, remote or virtual apps, games, and other destinations where paste is blocked or unreliable.

INPUT STYLE	WHAT THE DESTINATION RECEIVES	BEST STARTING POINT
Clipboard	Text pasted from the clipboard	Standard apps, editors, and terminals
Keystroke	The completed text one character at a time	Screen readers, RDP, Citrix, virtual apps, and game chat

Test the exact field where you plan to dictate. Applications can handle paste and simulated typing differently, even between fields in the same app.

Use Clipboard

Select **Controls** > **Input Style** > **Clipboard**. This is usually the faster option because Whisperstream pastes text instead of typing it one character at a time. On a Mac, it pastes with Command-V.

Clipboard temporarily replaces copied text while Whisperstream inserts the dictation. On **Home**, **Restore clipboard after dictation** controls whether Whisperstream restores the previous clipboard text afterward.

- Turn it on when you want to keep text you copied before dictating.
- Turn it off when you want the dictated text to remain available for another paste.
- Copied images and files cannot be restored. Only clipboard text is preserved.

If the destination blocks paste or no text appears, switch to Keystroke.

Use Keystroke

Select **Controls** > **Input Style** > **Keystroke**. Whisperstream types the completed text character by character and does not change the clipboard.

Use Keystroke first for:

- NVDA, JAWS, and other screen readers;
- Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP);
- Citrix and other virtual applications;
- game chat fields; and
- destinations where Clipboard is blocked or unreliable.

On Windows, if Whisperstream detects a screen reader before you choose an input style, it selects Keystroke automatically. A later manual choice takes precedence. Whisperstream does not detect VoiceOver on a Mac, so choose Keystroke yourself if you need it.

Keystroke can be slower, especially for long dictations. If a remote or virtual app drops characters or puts them out of order, open **Controls** > **Advanced** > **Typing Delay**. Start with **None**, then increase the delay one step at a time until the full phrase arrives correctly.

Account for destination restrictions

- **RDP, Citrix, and virtual apps:** Test inside the remote app, not only in a local field. Clipboard redirection and keyboard handling can differ.
- **Games:** Test a harmless chat field first. Some games and anti-cheat systems ignore simulated input, so neither style is guaranteed to work. Do not change game or operating-system protections to force delivery.
- **Mac apps:** Both input styles need Accessibility access. See **Allow access on a Mac**.
- **Elevated apps:** Windows may block input from an app running at a lower privilege level. If the destination runs as administrator and neither style works, run Whisperstream at the same privilege level and test again.

Test the destination

1. Focus the exact field where text should appear.
2. Dictate a short phrase with punctuation and any line breaks you need.
3. Confirm that every character appears once and in order.
4. If Clipboard fails, switch to Keystroke.

5. If Keystroke loses characters, increase **Typing Delay** one step and repeat.

If neither style works after these checks, treat that field as unsupported.

Dictionary filters and replacements

Filter unwanted words and replace recurring recognized terms in completed dictation.

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Correct recurring words

Use **Dictionary** to remove unwanted words, replace recognized wording, or help AI enhancement spell names and specialist terms. Each entry applies automatically to later dictations until you edit or remove it.

ENTRY	RESULT	EXAMPLE
Boost	Suggests a spelling to AI enhancement when a similar word or sound appears	Keep `TanStack` spelled correctly when it is heard as `tan stack`
Filter	Removes a matched word or phrase	Remove `um` from `Send it, um, tomorrow.`
Replace	Substitutes your chosen text for a match	Change `whisper stream` to `Whisperstream`

A new install starts with an empty Dictionary. Add only the entries that suit the way you speak. Pressing Enter in **Add a word…** adds a Filter, so select **Boost** or **Replace** when you want those instead.

Boost names and terms

Use Boost for a name, product, or technical term that recognition sometimes misspells or confuses with a similar-sounding word.

1. Open **Dictionary**.
2. Enter the correct spelling in **Add a word…**.
3. Select **Boost**.
4. Make a new dictation with AI enhancement on to test the result.

Boost requires AI enhancement and an enhancement model that supports it. Cloud providers, Ollama, Custom, Stream-1 Mini, and Customizable support Boost. When enhancement is off or the selected model does not support it, Dictionary shows a notice and keeps your saved words.

For each dictation, Whisperstream finds Boost words that look or sound like parts of the transcript and gives them to the enhancement model as spelling hints. The model decides whether a hint fits. Boost does not force a replacement, so use **Replace** when a wording should always change. Very short entries match only exact wording, and long phrases are not used as hints. If you use a cloud provider, the matching Boost words are sent with the transcript.

Add a filter

Use a filter when a word or phrase should disappear from completed text.

1. Open **Dictionary**.
2. Enter the unwanted wording in **Add a word...**.
3. Select **Filter**.
4. Make a new dictation to test the result.

Filters match complete words or phrases regardless of capitalization. A filter for `um` removes `um` and `Um`, but it does not remove those letters from the middle of another word. Whisperstream also cleans up extra horizontal spaces and nearby commas left by the removal.

RECOGNIZED TEXT	FILTER	RESULT
`Send it, um, tomorrow.`	`um`	`Send it, tomorrow.`
`Uh please open the report.`	`uh`	`please open the report.`

Use filters narrowly. Filtering an ordinary content word removes it every time it appears as a complete match, even when the word carries meaning in that sentence.

Add a replacement

Use a replacement when recognition is consistent but the spelling, capitalization, or wording should be different.

1. Open **Dictionary**.
2. Enter the recognized wording in **Add a word...**.
3. Select **Replace**.
4. Enter the desired result in **Replace with**.

5. Select **Save**, then test it in a new dictation.

Replacements match complete words or phrases regardless of capitalization and use the spelling and capitalization you saved. Other text-style settings can still affect the completed result.

RECOGNIZED TEXT	REPLACE WITH	RESULT
`whisper stream`	`Whisperstream`	`Whisperstream`
`acme cloud`	`ACME Cloud`	`ACME Cloud`
`doctor lee`	`Dr. Lee`	`Dr. Lee`

Use the source wording Whisperstream produces reliably. If a name is recognized in several forms, add one specific replacement for each form instead of one broad rule that could change unrelated text.

Understand matching order

When entries overlap, Whisperstream checks longer source phrases before shorter ones. For example, `acme cloud` is checked before `acme`.

Filters run before replacements. If the same wording appears in both entry types, the filter removes it before the replacement can apply.

Edit or remove an entry

Select an entry's edit control, change its source or replacement, and save. You can also press Enter to save or Escape to cancel while editing. Select the remove control to delete the entry. Changes apply to future completed dictations.

If a rule does not match, compare it with the exact wording in a new completed dictation. Check spelling and spaces, and remember that the match must begin and end on word boundaries.

Import a word list

Add many Boost words and replacements at once from a CSV file.

1. Open **Dictionary** and select **Import CSV**.
2. Drop a CSV file onto the import area, or select **Choose file**. Select **Download example CSV** to start from a sample.
3. Review the entries under **Ready to add**.

4. Select the **Import** button, which shows how many entries will be added.

The file needs a `word` column. A `replacement` column is optional. A row with a replacement becomes a Replace entry; a row without one becomes a Boost entry. Filters cannot be imported.

```
word,replacement
Whisperstream,
TanStack,
git hub,GitHub
```

Import never changes existing entries. Duplicates of entries you already have, and words that already have a different rule, are skipped and listed in the review. If any row has a problem, fix it in the CSV and choose the file again. Closing the import before you confirm adds nothing.

Local, Ollama, and cloud enhancement providers

Choose and configure where optional transcript cleanup runs.

EDITION 2.0.0

Choose where cleanup runs

AI Enhancement optionally cleans a completed dictation before Whisperstream inserts it. Choose **Local** to run cleanup on this computer, or configure Ollama, Gemini, OpenAI, Anthropic, or a Custom service. Enhancement is off by default.

PROVIDER	WHERE CLEANUP RUNS	WHAT YOU CONFIGURE
Local	On this computer	Stream-1 Mini (default) or Customizable (Gemma 4 E2B), with a model-specific speed check
Ollama	Where the selected Ollama model runs: this computer, another computer, or Ollama Cloud	**Endpoint** and exact **Model** name
Gemini	Google Gemini	**API key** and **Model**
OpenAI	OpenAI	**API key** and **Model**
Anthropic	Anthropic	**API key** and **Model**
Custom	The OpenAI-compatible service at your **Base URL**	**Base URL**, **Model**, and **API key**

Enable AI Enhancement

1. Open **Enhancement**.
2. Select a **Provider**.
3. Review any provider notices that appear. Continue only if you want to use that provider.
4. Complete the fields or guided Local setup shown for the provider.

5. Turn on **AI Enhancement** if it is still off.

For a configured service, wait for the status to show **Connected**. Local setup is complete when its download and speed check finish successfully. If setup fails, expand the connection card and follow the message shown.

The provider controls where cleanup runs. To choose how text is rewritten, see **Profiles and routing**.

Choose a cloud model

For Gemini, OpenAI, or Anthropic, open **Model** to choose from a curated list. The **Recommended** label identifies a suggested starting point for that provider.

Whisperstream uses the list bundled with the app and makes no model-list requests. A new release can update the list without changing your saved model IDs or selections. To use a model that is not listed, choose **Custom model name…** and enter its exact identifier. Your provider account must have access to that model.

Cloud providers still need an internet connection and their own account or API access. The bundled model list does not make cloud cleanup available offline.

If cleanup times out or fails

Whisperstream delivers Original text if a provider times out or returns an error. In a long dictation, affected parts use Original while successful parts remain enhanced.

The HUD then briefly names the provider and shows **timed out** or **returned an error**.

Adjust Thinking and output safeguards

Open **Enhancement** and expand **Advanced**. These settings apply to the provider and model you selected.

Thinking lets a supported model spend extra time before answering. **Off** is the default where the model allows it. Models that require thinking start at their lowest supported setting. When the control is unavailable, the provider's default applies, or the model keeps its fixed settings. Your choice is remembered for that model and connection across all profiles. Higher levels may take longer, and changing Thinking does not extend **Enhancement timeout**. Whisperstream inserts only the model's final text, without its reasoning.

Output safeguards is on by default. For Local, it repairs clear digit errors and uses the original transcript when the output fails its checks. For other providers, it uses the original transcript if the model refuses, repeats itself in a loop, or returns a runaway response. Turn it off to use the model's response without

these checks. Empty responses and failed requests still fall back to the original transcript. Safeguards are basic checks: they cannot catch every word a model changes or adds.

Set up Local enhancement

Choose **Local** when cleanup must remain on this computer. Stream-1 Mini is the default: Whisperstream's own cleanup model for English Chat and Email, with built-in prompts. Choose Customizable (Gemma 4 E2B) in the model picker when you want to write your own prompts. Customizable automatically uses the verified official Google Gemma backup if its primary download source is unavailable. A manually restored, verified Google Gemma artifact is also supported. The two Gemma artifacts may produce different results; the speed check measures the one in use. Local cleanup does not need an API key. Code profiles produce original text with Stream-1 Mini. Local enhancement works the same way on Windows and Mac.

1. Select **Local** under **Provider**.
2. The Local setup guide checks Stream-1 Mini. An existing file is reused; a missing one is downloaded first. Choose **Start speed check**. To use Customizable instead, choose it in the model picker; Whisperstream then checks only that model.
3. Follow the result shown to finish setup.
4. Turn on **AI Enhancement** if it is still off.

After setup, cleanup runs on this computer. Each model needs its own speed check. If one model cannot be downloaded, you can check and use the other independently. See **Install and recover models offline** for exact files, manual installation, and single-model setup.

Set up Gemini

Gemini is the recommended quick setup for a bring-your-own-key cloud provider.

1. Open Google's **Gemini API key guide** and sign in to Google AI Studio.
2. Create or select a Google Cloud project if prompted.
3. Create an API key and copy it. Follow Google's current restriction guidance on the same page.
4. In Whisperstream, select **Gemini** and paste the key into **API key**.
5. Keep the recommended **Model** or choose another available to your key, then complete the standard enablement steps above.

Google may offer a free tier for eligible accounts and models. Regional availability, limits, data terms, and pricing can change, so check the current **Gemini API pricing**.

Configure another provider

Ollama

Follow the official **Ollama quickstart**, then enter the server address in **Endpoint** and the exact model name in **Model**. Ollama supports **local and cloud models**, so confirm where the selected model runs before enabling enhancement.

OpenAI or Anthropic

Create a provider key, paste it into **API key**, and choose a **Model**. Use the official **OpenAI API quickstart** or **Anthropic API keys** page for current account steps. Provider terms and billing apply.

For Anthropic, the **Workspace ID** field appears only after a connection check reports a workspace problem. Copy the value from Anthropic Console and try again, or use a workspace-scoped API key that does not need this field. The field stays editable while you remain on the page with the same provider and key. Replacing or removing the Anthropic key also clears the saved workspace.

Custom

Select **Custom** for a service that accepts OpenAI-compatible requests. Enter its **Base URL**, exact **Model** identifier, and **API key**, then enable enhancement. Obtain those values from the service's documentation.

Profiles, Email mode, app detection, and site detection

Configure built-in and custom profiles, then route them by manual choice, website, or foreground application.

EDITION 2.0.0

Choose how enhancement rewrites text

An enhancement profile controls how a completed dictation is cleaned up. Set a default, use a Hotkey, or add app and website rules to choose the right style.

Whisperstream includes three built-in profiles:

PROFILE	USE IT FOR	RESULT
Chat	Messages, notes, and general prose	Cleans punctuation, casing, fillers, and dictated structure while preserving your meaning.
Code	Software-related dictation	Preserves technical intent and formats common code terms, filenames, identifiers, and acronyms. It does not write or refactor code.
Email	Dictated email	Organizes a greeting, body paragraphs, and a sign-off when you dictate one.

Built-in profiles have fixed icons and instructions and cannot be deleted. You can rename them, set a default, assign rules or a Hotkey, and edit the Email signature.

Stream-1 Mini supports Chat and Email cleanup in English with built-in prompts. While it is selected, a custom profile's prompt is shown but cannot be edited; switch to Customizable or a cloud provider to edit it. Code profiles remain saved but insert original text with Stream-1 Mini.

Profile cleanup runs only when enhancement is on. To enable enhancement or choose where cleanup runs, see **Enhancement providers**.

Choose a default or switch manually

The default profile handles recordings that do not match an app or website rule.

1. Open **Enhancement** and select a profile.
2. Choose **Make default**.

Choose **Remove as default** to clear it. If there is no default and no other rule applies, Whisperstream inserts the original transcript without enhancement.

To switch manually, open a profile and assign its **Hotkey**. The Hotkey selects the profile without recording and remains active in the same application. Switch applications or choose **Resume auto-routing** to return to automatic routing.

Create a custom profile

Use a custom profile when the built-in styles do not produce the result you want.

1. Open **Enhancement** and choose **Add profile**.
2. Enter a **Profile Name** and optionally choose an **Icon**. Keep the letter option to use the profile's first letter.
3. Write your **Cleanup prompt**, or choose a Blank, Chat, Code, or Email **Template** as a starting point.
4. Expand **Try it** and test representative dictation against the instructions.
5. Add any rules or Hotkey you need, then choose **Create**.

State the formatting, tone, and terms to preserve, then test before setting a default. Templates are editable examples, not copies of built-in instructions.

Custom profiles can be renamed, edited, or deleted. Deleting one also removes its rules.

Configure Email and its signature

Email structures dictated thoughts. Its cleanup adds a greeting or sign-off only when you dictate one. A saved Signature is separate.

Open the built-in Email profile and enter an optional **Signature**, for example:

```
Best,
Alex
```

Whisperstream appends it when Email runs and the dictation lacks a sign-off. Leave **Signature** blank to add nothing.

Add app and website rules

Open a profile, find **Activated when using**, and choose **Add**.

- Select **App** to choose a running or installed application. If it is missing, choose **Browse...** and select its executable.
- Select **Website** and enter a host such as `mail.google.com`. Subdomains are separate rules, so `mail.google.com` and `google.com` can use different profiles.

Remove a rule from its profile when you no longer want it.

See which profile is running

While enhancement will run, the recording indicator shows the effective profile's icon or initial during recording and processing. The mark covers manual, website, application, and default routing. It appears only for the active dictation and is absent when no profile applies.

For saved results, see **Transcript history**. Provider timeouts and other fallback behavior belong in **Enhancement providers**.

Understand routing order

Whisperstream selects one profile for each recording in this order:

1. Active manual Hotkey choice.
2. Matching website rule.
3. Matching application rule.
4. Default profile.

If none applies, enhancement is skipped. Normally, app and website rules use the destination active when recording starts. Switching windows while speaking does not change the match.

When the wrong profile runs, choose **Resume auto-routing** first, then review the website rule, application rule, and default in that order.

Transcript and audio history

Control saved transcript and audio history, recovery keys, retention, search, playback, copying, import, and deletion.

EDITION 2.0.0

If Transcripts shows **History is disabled**, your organization has disabled transcript and audio saving. You cannot enable either setting or start password setup. Dictation remains available. See **Managed Lockdown for organizations**.

Choose what history saves

Open **Transcripts** to search and use saved dictations and imported audio. Open **Transcript settings** to choose what new records contain and how long they remain.

SETTING	NEW-INSTALL DEFAULT	EFFECT
Save transcripts	On for Windows, off for Mac	Saves new completed dictations. Turning it off pauses new records without deleting existing history.
Save audio	On	Keeps the recording with each new transcript. It is available only while **Save transcripts** is on.
Keep for	7 days	Keeps records for **1 day**, **7 days**, **30 days**, or **Forever**.

On a Mac, nothing is saved until you turn on **Save transcripts** and complete the steps below. Turning **Save audio** off leaves existing audio in place. A shorter **Keep for** period asks for confirmation, then deletes older records and their audio. **Forever** turns off age-based deletion. Retention applies to dictations and imports.

Keep a recovery key

Saved history is encrypted. Its everyday key is stored in Keychain on a Mac or in your Windows account on a PC, so history opens without a password. A recovery key is your backup if that key is ever lost.

Turn on saving

1. Open **Transcript settings** and turn on **Save transcripts**.
2. In **Save transcripts on this Mac?** or **Save transcripts on this PC?**, choose **Enable saving**. On a Mac, macOS may ask to use Whisperstream's encryption key in Keychain. Allow access to continue.
3. Save your recovery key with **Copy**, **Print**, or **Download**.
4. Optional: select **Also add a recovery password** and enter it twice. Use at least 12 characters. Very common passwords are not accepted.
5. Select **I saved my recovery key somewhere other than this Mac** (**this PC** on Windows), then choose **Done**.

Done stays unavailable until you save the key and select the checkbox. Keep the key off this computer, for example in a password manager or on paper.

A recovery password is a second way to restore history. It doesn't lock history or add a password prompt.

If this computer loses its key and you also lose your recovery key and recovery password, your saved transcripts can't be recovered.

Finish setup for existing history

History saved without a recovery key keeps saving, but **Transcripts** shows **Finish recovery setup** instead of your records. Choose **Set up recovery key**, then follow steps 3 to 5 above. Whisperstream also shows a one-time prompt at launch, **Add a recovery key for your transcripts**, that opens the same setup.

Change recovery settings

Open **Transcript settings** and select **Recovery settings**.

- **Create new key** makes a replacement recovery key. Save it, select the checkbox, and choose **Done**. Your previous key stops working once you choose **Done**.
- **Add password**, **Change password**, and **Remove password** manage the recovery password. Removing it leaves your recovery key working.

Restore history if the key is missing

If Keychain on this Mac or Windows on this PC no longer has the key, Transcripts shows **Restore your transcript history** and saving pauses. Your saved transcripts stay on this computer until you restore them or start fresh.

1. If you added a recovery password, choose **Recovery key** or **Recovery password**.
2. Enter it and choose **Restore history**.

Whisperstream puts the key back in Keychain or your Windows account. History opens again, saving resumes, and you won't need the recovery key on this computer again.

After too many incorrect attempts, Whisperstream shows **Too many attempts** with a countdown. Wait for it to finish, then try again.

If no recovery key was set up, the screen explains that your transcripts can't be restored and offers only **Start fresh**.

Start fresh

Start fresh permanently deletes all saved transcripts and audio without opening them. It can't be undone.

1. Choose **Lost your key? Start fresh** (or **Lost both? Start fresh** if you added a recovery password).
2. Review **Start fresh without your history?** and choose **Continue**.
3. Type `DELETE`, then choose **Delete all saved transcripts**.
4. Save your new recovery key, select the checkbox, and choose **Done**.

If you find your old recovery key later, it won't work with the new history.

Find and open a transcript

The Transcripts page shows the newest records first. Enter a word or phrase in **Search transcripts...** to narrow the list, then select a record to expand it.

Records label the recognized text and optional cleanup separately:

- **Original** is the transcript produced before enhancement.
- **Enhanced** is the cleaned-up version. Open the record and use **Show original** or **Show enhanced** to switch between them.

Version details reflect what happened during that recording:

- Success shows **Enhanced** and the profile that ran.
- Partial fallback keeps **Enhanced**, names the profile, and explains that some original wording was kept.
- Complete timeout or failure keeps **Original** and explains why the original was used.

Older records may show **Original** or **Enhanced** without a profile or explanation. Whisperstream does not guess missing details from current settings.

To change which profile applies to future recordings, see **Profiles and routing**.

An expanded record lets you:

- Read the complete transcript.
- Use **Copy transcript** to copy the version currently shown.
- Play, pause, and seek through a saved recording.
- Select **Save a copy** to save that recording as a WAV file in a location you choose.

- Use **Delete transcript** to remove the record and its audio.

You can also copy a collapsed record. Copy uses the complete formatted text, not the shortened preview. It copies **Enhanced** when available and otherwise **Original**. After expansion, Copy follows the version shown.

If a record has no saved audio, its transcript remains available but the player and **Save a copy** action do not appear.

Import an audio file

Turn on **Save transcripts** before importing audio. Then:

1. Open **Transcripts** and select **Add file**.
2. Drop audio files into the import area, or select **Choose files**.
3. Keep Whisperstream open while each file is processed.
4. Wait for the file to show **Done**, then return to the list and open its transcript.

WAV files always work. Other formats, such as MP3 or M4A, may not import on every setup. A file that shows **Failed** does not stop the remaining files in the queue.

Imported records follow your **Save audio** and **Keep for** choices. If **Save audio** is off, Whisperstream keeps the imported transcript without a playable recording.

Whisperstream does not upload the source audio. If online enhancement is enabled, it can send the resulting transcript to your configured provider.

Delete saved history

Deletion actions require confirmation. Deleted records cannot be restored in Whisperstream.

- Use **Delete transcript** on one record to delete that transcript and its associated audio.
- Open **Transcript settings** and select **Delete all transcripts** to delete every record and saved recording.
- Choose a shorter **Keep for** period to delete records older than that period.

Turning **Save transcripts** off only pauses new records. Use one of the deletion actions when you want to remove records already saved.

If the Transcripts page asks for a transcript password, see **Lockdown Mode** for its history controls.

Lockdown Mode

Enable, use, recover, or turn off password-gated Lockdown Mode.

EDITION 2.0.0

What Lockdown Mode changes

Lockdown Mode limits AI cleanup to **Local**, makes cloud providers and Ollama unavailable, and can protect saved history with a password.

It does not control the app receiving inserted text. While Lockdown is effective, Whisperstream suspends **Agent Speak** processing; it does not stop the connected coding agents themselves.

It is off by default. Open **Home**, find **Lockdown Mode**, and turn it on to begin.

Turn on Lockdown Mode

1. If the acknowledgment screen appears, review the setup summary, select the acknowledgment, and choose **Continue**.
2. Choose **Keep encrypted history** or **Don't save transcripts**.

Keep encrypted history

1. Choose whether **Save audio** is on.
2. Under **Keep for**, select **1 day**, **7 days**, **30 days**, or **Forever**.
3. Create and confirm a transcript password. Use at least 12 characters. Very common passwords are not accepted.
4. Save the recovery key with **Copy**, **Print**, or **Download**.
5. Select **I've saved my recovery key somewhere other than this computer**, then choose **Finish setup**.

Whisperstream shows the recovery key once. Keep it somewhere other than this computer. Your password or current recovery key can reopen locked history.

Passwords created before the 12-character rule still unlock history. The rule applies when you set or change a password.

Don't save transcripts

This stops saving new records without creating a password or recovery key. Existing records are not deleted.

If you change your mind, open **Home > Lockdown Mode > Manage**, choose **Start saving transcripts**, and complete the password and recovery key steps.

Lock and unlock transcript history

Password-backed history locks after inactivity. The default is **5 min**. To change it, open **Home > Lockdown Mode > Manage** and set **Lock transcripts after idle** to **Never**, **5 min**, **10 min**, **15 min**, **30 min**, or **1 hour**. This locks history, not the app.

Enter your password to unlock history, or choose **Use recovery key instead**. After unlocking with the recovery key, you set a new password.

Manage also offers **Change password** and **View recovery key**. **View recovery key** asks for your password, then **Generate a new key** replaces the current key, which stops working. Save the new key and select the checkbox before choosing **Done**.

Use Local enhancement

While Lockdown Mode is on, **Local** is the only available enhancement provider. Entering Lockdown from another provider selects Local and turns enhancement off. An enabled, ready Local setup can remain enabled.

To use cleanup under Lockdown, complete the Local setup and then turn on **AI Enhancement**. See **Enhancement providers** for the Local download and speed-check steps.

If your organization manages Lockdown

Home may show **Managed by your organization**. This removes turn-off and destructive-reset actions. Unless your organization also disables history, you can still manage transcript saving, your password, recovery key, and idle lock. When history is disabled, transcript and audio saving stay off and password setup is unavailable. You can still dictate. Contact your administrator if the device should no longer be managed.

For enterprise capabilities and deployment guidance, see **Managed Lockdown for organizations**. Managed Lockdown is available on Windows only. On a Mac, you turn Lockdown Mode on and off yourself.

Export safe diagnostics

Safe local diagnostics remain available in voluntary and managed Lockdown. **Export logs** creates a local ZIP only when requested and never uploads it. It excludes transcript and audio content, credentials, recovery keys, and the access log. See **Settings and data locations** for steps.

Turn off Lockdown Mode

1. Open **Home > Lockdown Mode > Manage**.
2. Choose **Turn off Lockdown Mode**.
3. Enter the transcript password if you chose **Keep encrypted history**.
4. Choose **Turn off**.

If you chose **Don't save transcripts**, no password is required. Turning Lockdown off makes cloud providers and Ollama available again. Existing transcripts remain on this device and no longer need the Lockdown password. Your Lockdown recovery key and password stay set up as recovery methods for standard history. See **Transcript history** to change them. **Local** stays selected and AI Enhancement stays off until you choose otherwise.

Reset when recovery is impossible

If you cannot use either the transcript password or recovery key, open the turn-off dialog and choose **I forgot my password**. This is a destructive reset.

Type `DELETE`, then choose **Delete history and turn off Lockdown**. The reset deletes saved transcripts and audio, turns off Lockdown Mode, and the old records cannot be restored in Whisperstream.

Managed Lockdown for organizations

Understand Managed Lockdown capabilities, user controls, and security boundaries.

EDITION 2.0.0

What Managed Lockdown offers

Managed Lockdown lets an organization make Whisperstream's Lockdown master control administrator-owned on managed Windows devices. It is not available for Mac. It keeps Lockdown on and limits enhancement to **Local**, so cloud providers and Ollama remain unavailable.

When the administrator's management assignment remains in place, the control is reapplied across configuration changes, restarts, updates, app-data deletion, and reinstalls. Whisperstream shows **Managed by your organization** instead of offering the user a way to turn Lockdown off or perform its destructive reset.

Managed Lockdown is designed to resist changes by a standard Windows user. It is not a security boundary against someone who controls a local administrator account, device policy, or the installed application. Organizations should manage administrator access through their normal Windows security and endpoint-management practices.

What users can still control

With only `ManagedLockdown=1`, users retain their transcript-history choices. With the optional `DisableHistory=1` policy, transcript and audio saving stay off and users cannot enable them. This option is intended for new installations and must be applied before first launch. It does not delete or migrate any existing history.

Without the history restriction, users can still:

- choose whether to save transcripts;
- manage their transcript password and recovery key;
- choose the transcript-history idle-lock interval; and
- export local support diagnostics. This remains available when history is disabled.

A newly managed setup starts with transcript history off. With `DisableHistory=1`, it stays off even if a user edits configuration or attempts password setup. ManagedLockdown alone preserves existing history choices and password settings. Existing-history migration and deletion are outside the no-history deployment scope. See **Lockdown Mode** for the user workflow and **Settings and data locations** for **Download logs**.

Before deployment

You need the Whisperstream Windows installer, local administrator rights or a device-management agent running as SYSTEM, and the required model files. Pilot the deployment on a test device with a standard Windows user before rolling it out.

Managed Lockdown uses the **64-bit machine registry**, not a per-user setting. Protect that location with normal Windows permissions. Do not grant standard users permission to create, change, or remove the policy, and control who has local administrator access.

> Important: Your IT team is responsible for making sure users cannot change the policy values. Check the permissions on `HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream` and keep your management tool's assignment in place. Whisperstream enforces the values it finds at startup, but it cannot stop someone with administrator rights from editing or removing them.

Enable during installation

Run the installer from an elevated PowerShell window. Use Whisperstream 2.0 or later; older installers do not enforce `DisableHistory`. Change the filename below to match your installer:

```
$installer = Start-Process `
  -FilePath '.\Whisperstream_2.0.0_x64-setup.exe' `
  -ArgumentList '/S', '/MANAGEDLOCKDOWN=1', '/DISABLEHISTORY=1' `
  -Wait -PassThru
$installer.ExitCode
```

`/S` installs silently. `/DISABLEHISTORY=1` writes and verifies the independent no-history machine policy. `/MANAGEDLOCKDOWN=1` writes and verifies the machine policy. Require a successful exit code and verify the registry value below. An invalid policy argument exits with code `87`; inability to write or verify policy exits with `740`. There is no per-user fallback.

Omitting either policy argument leaves that value unchanged. Both arguments accept only `1`; use the removal procedure to clear a restriction.

Apply registry policy before first launch

In an elevated PowerShell window, run:

```
reg.exe add "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream" `
  /v ManagedLockdown /t REG_DWORD /d 1 /f /reg:64
if ($LASTEXITCODE -ne 0) { throw 'Policy write failed.' }
reg.exe add "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream" `
  /v DisableHistory /t REG_DWORD /d 1 /f /reg:64
if ($LASTEXITCODE -ne 0) { throw 'History policy write failed.' }
```

Quit Whisperstream from its tray menu, then start it again. Closing its window alone may leave it running. External policy changes take effect at the next application start, before content-capable services start.

Deploy with Intune, Group Policy, or another management tool

Configure the following machine values through your organization's Windows device-management tooling:

SETTING	REQUIRED VALUE
Hive	`HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE`
Key	`SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream`
Registry view	64-bit
Value names	`ManagedLockdown` and `DisableHistory` (two separate values)
Value type	`REG_DWORD`
Value data	`1`

For Intune scripts or Win32 remediations, use device context with administrator or SYSTEM rights. For Group Policy Preferences, use Computer Configuration and the 64-bit registry view. The `reg.exe` command above explicitly selects that view even when invoked by a 32-bit management process. Schedule an application restart after applying policy.

For each value, any nonzero DWORD enables its restriction. `DisableHistory` is enforced independently: removing or setting `ManagedLockdown` to zero does not permit history while `DisableHistory` remains enabled. DWORD `0` or absence leaves that restriction inactive. An unreadable key enforces both

restrictions. A present value of the wrong type or an unreadable policy key fails closed, so repair its type or permissions rather than expecting it to disable management.

Provision models for offline use

Managed Lockdown still allows model downloads. For a device that must operate without internet access, provision the files before use with **Model recovery and manual installation**. That chapter lists exact formats, filenames, checksums, and folders for each supported model.

The default model folders belong to the Windows user running Whisperstream. `%LOCALAPPDATA%` in a SYSTEM deployment script refers to the system profile, not the intended user's profile. Copy files into each intended user's model folders, or deliberately configure the supported model location for that user. Keep filenames and directory structure intact, and give that user access to the files.

Include the transcription model selected during setup. Local enhancement is optional; if required, provision Stream-1 Mini, Gemma 4 E2B, or both. The Local setup check measures Stream-1 Mini; to use Gemma instead, choose Customizable in the model picker so only that model is checked. Complete files already in their recognized locations are reused. Verify the documented checksums before launch because presence alone does not establish file integrity.

Verify the deployment

Query both explicit 64-bit values:

```
reg.exe query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream" `
  /v ManagedLockdown /reg:64
if ($LASTEXITCODE -ne 0) { throw 'Policy query failed.' }
reg.exe query "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream" `
  /v DisableHistory /reg:64
if ($LASTEXITCODE -ne 0) { throw 'History policy query failed.' }
```

Expect both values to be `REG_DWORD` with data `0x1`. Then:

1. Quit and restart Whisperstream as the intended standard user.
2. On Home, confirm Lockdown is on and labeled **Managed by your organization**. The user must not be able to disable it or use its destructive reset.
3. Confirm enhancement is Local and cloud providers, Ollama, custom remote endpoints, and non-loopback Local overrides are unavailable.
4. Confirm the intended transcription model is recognized. Test dictation and, if needed, the Local enhancement check. Test offline after provisioning if network isolation is required.
5. On a fresh profile, confirm Transcripts shows **History is disabled** and **Transcript and audio history are disabled by your organization.** Save transcripts and Save audio must stay off; no

history/password setup action should be offered. Dictate a synthetic test phrase, restart, and confirm no history entry or recording was saved. Verify attempts to enable saving through configuration or the local API are rejected or overridden.

6. Restart again and confirm management persists. Include update, uninstall/reinstall, and policy-removal checks in your disposable pilot environment before organization-wide rollout.

Avoid deleting production app data to test policy persistence. It can destroy user history even though the machine policy remains.

Remove management

First remove any device-management assignment that would restore the value. Then run this command as an administrator. Remove both named values to lift both restrictions. Removing only `ManagedLockdown` leaves history disabled:

```
reg.exe delete "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream" `
  /v ManagedLockdown /f /reg:64
if ($LASTEXITCODE -ne 0) { throw 'Policy removal failed.' }
reg.exe delete "HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Whisperstream" `
  /v DisableHistory /f /reg:64
if ($LASTEXITCODE -ne 0) { throw 'History policy removal failed.' }
```

Quit and restart Whisperstream. The user regains authority over Lockdown, but an already-enabled Lockdown state stays on until they deliberately turn it off. Removing policy does not automatically start saving history, decrypt history or remove its password.

Updates, uninstall, reinstall, and app-data deletion leave this organization-owned registry policy in place. Uninstalling Whisperstream is not a policy-removal procedure.

Troubleshoot deployment

- **The managed label is missing:** verify the value is under HKLM in the 64-bit view, is a DWORD set to `1`, and was written successfully. Quit the tray process and relaunch.
- **The policy returns after removal:** remove or change the management assignment that is reapplying it.
- **Management remains after a registry edit:** check for an unreadable key or a malformed value, then restart. Invalid present policy fails closed.
- **A model is missing or a download starts:** check the actual user's data directory, required filenames, and complete file set against the recovery chapter. Files placed under the deployment agent's profile are not the user's cache.
- **A user lost access to history:** use their recovery key. Managed Lockdown provides no administrator password escrow or central unlock, and blocks the destructive Lockdown reset while managed.

Applying or removing policy does not recover encrypted history.

Network requirements

Managed Lockdown is not an internet-disconnection switch. Optional model acquisition uses HTTPS with `huggingface.co`, `*.huggingface.co`, `hf.co`, and `*.hf.co`. Parakeet v2/v3, Qwen and Cohere downloads can also use exact upstream sherpa-onnx release archives at `github.com`, redirected to `release-assets.githubusercontent.com`, after the Hugging Face source remains unavailable. The app verifies its shipped archive checksum before extraction and the required file checksums before installation. Customizable can automatically try its pinned official Google Gemma backup through Hugging Face when its primary source is unavailable. Gemma and Stream-1 Mini have no automatic GitHub backup. Upstream Kokoro uses Hugging Face with no automatic backup source.

These requests send download and connection metadata, not transcript or audio content. Whisperstream makes no license-validation, application-update or in-app review/feedback submission requests. About external help links are user-initiated and unavailable in Lockdown. Local log and documentation exports remain available. Use the manual recovery instructions to provision supported model files without downloading them through the app.

For an offline deployment, retain and provision the model files and apply your organization's network controls. During a pilot, inspect process-scoped traffic while exercising model acquisition, local enhancement, and attempted remote enhancement. Local app and model-server communication uses loopback.

Understand the boundary

Managed Lockdown controls Whisperstream's transcription, enhancement, and history behavior. It does not control the destination app that receives inserted text. Apply the organization's own storage, sync, sharing, and network rules to that app.

While Lockdown is effective, Whisperstream suspends Agent Speak processing. This does not stop Codex or Claude Code themselves or govern their configured services.

This no-history option controls saved transcript/audio history. It does not disable content-free diagnostics or promise that every file workflow is memory-only; imported/uploaded audio can require temporary decoding files.

Safe diagnostics remain local unless a user deliberately saves and shares an export. The export excludes transcript and audio content, credentials, recovery keys, and the Lockdown access log.

Agent Speak for Codex and Claude Code

Connect Codex or Claude Code, read or hear short summaries, and reply through the HUD.

EDITION 2.0.0

Connect Agent Speak

Agent Speak shows Codex and Claude Code replies in Whisperstream's HUD. You can read a short written summary, hear it through local speech, and dictate a reply after an agent finishes.

Agent Speak connects to coding agents on your computer. While Lockdown Mode is effective, Whisperstream suspends Agent Speak processing. This does not stop a connected agent from using its configured model service independently.

Install Codex or Claude Code and open it at least once. Then:

1. Open **Agents** in Whisperstream and select **Enable Agents** or **Continue setup**.
2. Under **Connect your coding agents**, select **Connect** for Codex, Claude Code, or both.
3. For Codex CLI, run `/hooks` and trust Whisperstream. In the Codex app, open **Settings > Hooks > Whisperstream** and select **Trust all**. For Claude Code, run `/reload-plugins` if Whisperstream says its plugin was installed or updated.
4. Choose **Show summaries**, **Read replies aloud**, or both. Setup starts with both selected and requires at least one. If you choose speech, select a local voice model and voice, then adjust **Speed**. Continue starts the model download if needed.
5. Set the shortcut that opens the full response, then follow the final on-screen test with your connected agent.

The test checks your selected response mode and voice replies. Claude Code also presents a practice structured question. Codex does not provide structured questions to Agent Speak.

After you select **Connect**, Agent Speak stays on while Codex hook trust is pending. The Codex row changes to **Connected** automatically after trust is confirmed. After setup, use **General**, **Voice**, and **Connections** in Agents to change settings. To repair a connection, open **Connections**, select **Disconnect**, then **Connect** again. Follow any status instruction shown below the agent.

Pause Agent Speak

To stop Agent Speak for a while without disconnecting anything, open **Agents > General** and turn off the **Agents** switch. Summaries, speech, and replies stop for every coding agent, and **Connections** shows each agent as **Paused**. Your connections, Codex hook trust, and voice and summary settings are kept. Turn the switch back on to resume with the same agents.

Pausing does not stop Codex or Claude Code themselves. To remove one agent's connection instead, use **Disconnect** in **Connections**.

View responses and dictate replies

Turn on **Show summaries** to display the agent's short written summary when it finishes. This is independent of **Voice**, so you can read summaries without hearing them. New installations start with both settings off; completing setup saves your selections.

Use **View full response** to expand the complete reply, even with automatic summaries off. The default shortcut is **Ctrl+Alt+backtick**, and you can replace or clear it in Agent Speak settings. Existing saved shortcuts are not changed automatically.

Reply window controls how long your normal dictation shortcut answers the response that just finished. Choose 1 to 30 seconds, or **Off** to disable temporary replies. Setup selects 20 seconds with written summaries or 6 seconds with speech alone. In General, enabling summaries changes a 6-second window to 20 seconds; disabling them changes 20 back to 6. Other values stay unchanged.

During that window, start dictation with your usual Push to Talk or Toggle shortcut. Your draft appears in the HUD:

- With **Send replies automatically** off, review the draft and press Enter to send it. This is the default.
- With **Send replies automatically** on, Whisperstream sends it when dictation finishes.

Claude Code can also send structured questions to the HUD. Expand the question, then press the displayed number for your answer. Codex structured questions remain in Codex. Press Escape to close the response or defer a Claude Code question without answering it.

For replies after this temporary window closes, see **Coding agent sessions**.

Configure local speech

In **Agents > Voice**, turn on **Voice** to hear replies through local speech. Use **What to read** to choose **Spoken summary**, **Full response when short**, or **Full response**. Code blocks and raw links are skipped.

Choose a **Voice model**:

CHOICE	BEHAVIOR
Automatic	Uses Higher quality when 2 GB of memory is free, otherwise Lower memory. Downloads both models.
Higher quality	Uses Kokoro, which uses up to 1.5 GB of memory while speaking.
Lower memory	Uses Supertonic, which starts faster and uses up to 400 MB of memory while speaking.

Lower memory is the default on Windows, and Automatic is the default on Mac. Choosing Automatic or Higher quality downloads Kokoro from Hugging Face; it has no automatic backup source. Each voice model keeps its own voice choice.

Change **Voice model**, **Voice**, **Speed**, and **Volume** here. Voice previews are available in the picker. For the playback destination, see **Audio**.

A voice model stays loaded between replies and unloads after 30 minutes without speech to free memory. To change this, expand **Advanced** in **Agents > Voice** and set **Unload voice model when idle** to **Never**, **5 min**, **10 min**, **15 min**, **30 min**, or **1 hour**. After the model unloads, the next spoken reply may take a moment to start.

Use **Speak in** to choose when speech is requested:

CHOICE	BEHAVIOR
Every session	The default once Voice is enabled. Requests speech from every connected session.
When I ask	Use `/whisperstream:speak` in a Claude Code session or `$speak` in a Codex session.

In Claude Code, `/whisperstream:speak Project name` also names the session. Use `/whisperstream:name Project name` to name or rename it, or `/whisperstream:name` to clear that name. Named sessions show their names in the HUD, and their spoken summaries begin with the name.

Managed Codex and Claude Code sessions

Start Codex or Claude Code through the Whisperstream CLI so sessions remain available for HUD and voice replies.

EDITION 2.0.0

Install the Whisperstream CLI

Start Codex or Claude Code through the optional Whisperstream CLI when you want its session to remain available in the HUD after a turn ends. This lets you return to a coding session and dictate a reply later, instead of relying on Agent Speak's temporary reply window.

First, connect the coding agent you plan to use. See **Agent Speak** for connection, trust, and speech setup. Then:

1. Open **Agents** in Whisperstream, then select **Connections**.
2. Find **Whisperstream CLI** and select **Install**.
3. If the status asks you to, open a new terminal before using the command.

On a Mac, Install adds the `whisperstream` command to `~/.local/bin` and adds that folder to your PATH in your zsh and bash profiles. Open a new terminal window afterward.

Use **Uninstall** in the same place to remove the Whisperstream command from your PATH. This does not uninstall Codex, Claude Code, or Whisperstream.

Start a coding agent session

Open Windows Terminal, or a terminal window on a Mac, and run the command for your coding agent:

```
whisperstream codex
whisperstream claude
```

Arguments after the agent name pass to that coding agent unchanged. For example:

```
whisperstream codex resume --last
whisperstream claude --model opus
```

On Windows, voice replies are tested in Windows Terminal only. They may work in another terminal. On a Mac, use the command in a zsh or bash terminal. If Whisperstream cannot connect the session, Codex or Claude Code continues normally.

Remote Codex sessions are not available for HUD replies. Running `whisperstream codex --remote` still starts Codex normally, with voice replies off.

Return to a session in the HUD

Use your **View full response** shortcut to open the HUD. Each active CLI-started session appears under **Coding agent sessions**, identified by its coding agent and session name.

When several sessions are open, select a tab or use these shortcuts:

- `Ctrl+1` through `Ctrl+9` selects a session by position. On a Mac, use `Cmd+1` through `Cmd+9`.
- `Ctrl+Tab` moves to the next session.
- `Ctrl+Shift+Tab` moves to the previous session.

The selected session shows its latest response and whether it can accept a reply. If it is read-only, continue in its terminal and wait until the agent finishes before trying again.

To reply, select a session that can accept input and start dictation with your usual Push to Talk or Toggle shortcut. Review the draft in the HUD, then press Enter to send it. Press Escape to cancel the draft and close the HUD without ending the coding agent session. Agent Speak's automatic-send and speech settings still apply; configure them in **Agent Speak**.

Closing the terminal ends that coding agent session and removes it from the HUD. Closing or restarting Whisperstream does not stop the coding agent. The session reconnects when Whisperstream is available again. If the provider is disconnected, the app version is incompatible, or a connection cannot be established, the coding agent continues normally and HUD replies remain off.

Settings and data locations

Find settings and local data, move downloaded models, export logs, and choose what survives uninstall.

EDITION 2.0.0

Find a setting

Whisperstream groups settings by feature. Use this map when you know what you want to change but not where to find it.

PAGE	SETTINGS AND ACTIONS
Home	Language, speech model, theme, startup, model storage location, and Mac permissions.
Audio	Input device, recording chimes, chime volume, and Audio While Recording.
Controls	Recording shortcuts, last-transcript shortcuts, insertion method, and Live Preview.
Dictionary	Boost words, filtered words, word replacements, and CSV import.
Enhancement	Provider, model, API key, profile, and app or site routing.
Transcripts	History saving, audio saving, retention, search, and deletion.
Agents	Agent Speak, voices, and Whisperstream CLI setup for coding agent sessions.
About	Version, updates, support, offline documentation, legal documents, and log export.

Changes save as you make them. A restart is usually unnecessary unless Whisperstream asks for one.

For the CLI installation and session workflow, see **Coding agent sessions**.

Find Whisperstream data

Whisperstream keeps its user data under the signed-in Windows account. Enter this path in File Explorer's address bar to open the default folder:

`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream`

ITEM	LOCATION
Settings, usage data, and transcript history	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream`
Saved recording audio	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\recordings`
Diagnostic logs	`%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\logs`
Downloaded speech and voice models	`<model storage>\models`
Downloaded Local enhancement models	`<model storage>\local-llm`

The model storage folder defaults to `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream`. If you move it, only the two model folders use the new location. Settings, history, recordings, and logs stay in the default data folder.

On a Mac

Whisperstream keeps its data under your macOS user account. In Finder, choose **Go > Go to Folder** and enter the path.

ITEM	LOCATION
Settings, usage data, and transcript history	`~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream`
Saved recording audio	`~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream/recordings`
Diagnostic logs	`~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream/logs`
Downloaded Parakeet v3 model	`~/Library/Application Support/FluidAudio/Models`
Other speech and voice models	`~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream/models`
Downloaded Local enhancement models	`~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream/local-llm`

The transcript encryption key is stored in Keychain.

Move downloaded models

Move managed models when you want to free space on the drive that contains your Windows app data.

1. Open **Home** and expand **Advanced**.
2. Under **Model storage location**, select **Browse**.
3. Choose a stable local folder and review the folder check.
4. Select **Move files**. If compatible Whisperstream models are already there, select **Use this folder** instead.
5. Keep Whisperstream open until you see **Models moved**, then select **Done**.

Dictation and Local enhancement pause during the move and resume when it finishes. If the move fails, the original files remain in place. Select **Reset to default** to move managed models back to the standard location.

On a Mac, **Model storage location** moves only the Parakeet v3 model. Other speech, voice, and Local enhancement models stay in Whisperstream's data folder.

Export logs

Open **About** and select **Export logs**, then choose where to save `whisperstream-logs.zip`. You can inspect the ZIP locally or share it with someone helping you investigate. Export it soon after a problem occurs so it contains the most useful recent information.

Log export remains available in voluntary and administrator-managed Lockdown. Whisperstream never uploads the ZIP automatically. See **Lockdown Mode** for the controls that change in that mode.

Choose what survives uninstall

The Windows uninstaller includes the checkbox **Also delete settings and downloaded files**.

- Leave it cleared to keep `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream`. Your settings, transcript history, saved audio, logs, and models in the default location will be available after reinstalling under the same Windows account.
- Select it to remove that default data folder along with the app. If your custom model storage folder is outside the default folder, it remains, so delete that custom folder separately if you no longer need it.

On a Mac, moving Whisperstream to the Trash leaves its data in place. To remove it, quit Whisperstream and delete `~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream`. Delete the Parakeet v3 model from `~/Library/Application Support/FluidAudio/Models`, or from the folder you moved it to, if you no longer need it.

Install and recover models offline

Restore the exact speech and cleanup models, verify their files, and set up local enhancement independently.

EDITION 2.0.0

Whisperstream can use model files that you download yourself or copy from another installation. Use this guide if an in-app download fails, a model link stops working, or you want to prepare a new computer without connecting Whisperstream to the internet.

You need **one speech-recognition model** to dictate. **Local enhancement is optional** and can use Stream-1 Mini or Customizable. Customizable has two supported Gemma artifacts; you only need one of them.

This guide covers the exact model files supported by Whisperstream. Paths use Windows examples; see **Restore models on a Mac** for Mac folders and the one model that differs. The PDF and Markdown documentation do not include the model weights. Keep a separate backup of the model files and your installer or source revision and build instructions.

Model download sources

In-app model downloads use pinned files from Hugging Face. Supported speech-recognition models also have the GitHub backups described below. Existing compatible cached files stay usable. The upstream links in this guide identify the exact supported artifacts for manual recovery.

Automatic download backups

For Parakeet v2/v3, Qwen and Cohere, Whisperstream first tries the pinned Hugging Face files. If that source remains unavailable after retries, it tries the matching upstream sherpa-onnx GitHub release archive linked below. The app verifies the archive against a checksum shipped with the app before unpacking it, then verifies the required model files before installation. It preserves existing nonempty files. Cancellation, disk errors, checksum mismatches and download-policy failures stop the operation instead of switching sources.

Customizable first downloads Unsloth's pinned Gemma 4 E2B Q4_K_M file. If that source remains unavailable, it automatically tries Google's official pinned QAT Q4_0 file through Hugging Face. These are different artifacts with different checksums and may produce different results. The app verifies the

downloaded file and checks the artifact it will actually use. Cancellation, disk errors, checksum or size mismatches and download-policy failures stop the operation instead of switching sources. Stream-1 Mini has no automatic backup. If the automatic sources fail, use the manual recovery steps below. Only the exact supported artifacts listed here are recognized; a similar name does not make another file compatible.

Choose what to restore

WHAT YOU NEED	MODEL	REQUIRED FORMAT	APPROXIMATE SPACE FOR MODEL FILES
English dictation	NVIDIA Parakeet TDT 0.6B v2	sherpa-onnx INT8 ONNX bundle	661 MB
Dictation in Parakeet's supported non-English languages	NVIDIA Parakeet TDT 0.6B v3	sherpa-onnx INT8 ONNX bundle	670 MB
Dictation in Qwen's supported languages	Qwen3-ASR 0.6B	sherpa-onnx INT8 ONNX bundle	987 MB
Optional recognition in Cohere's supported languages	Cohere Transcribe, 14-language export	sherpa-onnx INT8 ONNX bundle	2.9 GB
Customizable local cleanup	Google Gemma 4 E2B Instruct	GGUF, Q4_K_M	3.1 GB
Automatic backup for Customizable	Google Gemma 4 E2B Instruct QAT	GGUF, Q4_0	3.35 GB
English dictation cleanup (default)	Stream-1 Mini	GGUF, Q4_K_M	484 MB

Sizes use decimal MB and GB. Windows may display different numbers. Allow additional space if you download an archive and then extract it. Disk space alone does not determine whether a model will run well on your computer.

For the full language list, see **Languages and models**.

Find the correct storage folder

With the default settings, Whisperstream stores models under:

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream
```

Paste that path into File Explorer's address bar. Windows expands `%LOCALAPPDATA%` to the current user's local application-data folder. Create the folder if it does not exist yet.

Speech models go inside its `models` folder. Enhancement models go inside `local-llm`, next to `models`:

```
Whisperstream\
  models\
    nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v2-int8\
    nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v3-int8\
    qwen3-asr-0.6b-int8\
    cohere-transcribe-03-2026-int8\
  local-llm\
    gemma-4-E2B-it-Q4_K_M.gguf
    gemma-4-E2B_q4_0-it.gguf
    stream-1-mini-vocabulary-q4_k_m.gguf
```

Only create the folders for models you want to install.

If you changed Model storage location: use the location shown under **Home > Advanced > Model storage location** as the base instead. For example, if you selected `D:\WhisperstreamModels`, speech models belong in `D:\WhisperstreamModels\models\...` and enhancement files belong in `D:\WhisperstreamModels\local-llm\...`. Do not add another `Whisperstream` folder beneath that base.

If you use a custom data directory: `WHISPERSTREAM_DATA_DIR` changes the default base. A saved custom model-storage location still takes precedence. For a normal new installation without either override, use the `%LOCALAPPDATA%` paths in this guide.

Restore models on a Mac

On a Mac, the default base folder is `~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream`. In Finder, choose **Go > Go to Folder** and enter the path. Use the same `models` and `local-llm` layout shown above:

```
~/Library/Application Support/Whisperstream/
  models/
    nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v2-int8/
    qwen3-asr-0.6b-int8/
    cohere-transcribe-03-2026-int8/
  local-llm/
    gemma-4-E2B-it-Q4_K_M.gguf
    gemma-4-E2B_q4_0-it.gguf
    stream-1-mini-vocabulary-q4_k_m.gguf
```

Parakeet v2, Qwen3-ASR, Cohere Transcribe, Gemma 4 E2B, and Stream-1 Mini use the same files and checksums as Windows.

Parakeet v3 is different on an Apple Silicon Mac. It runs on an Apple silicon engine and uses a Core ML version of the model, not the ONNX bundle in this guide. The ONNX files cannot replace it. Whisperstream downloads it from **FluidInference/parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v3-coreml** at revision `aed02740059203c4a87495924f685de3722ae9ce` and checks every file before use. It is stored in:

```
~/Library/Application Support/FluidAudio/Models/parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v3/
```

If you moved it with **Model storage location**, it is under the folder you chose. To restore it without downloading, copy the complete `parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v3` folder from a working Mac's backup into that location. Otherwise, let Whisperstream download it again.

Experimental Intel Mac source builds use the same ONNX speech model files and checksums as Windows, including Parakeet v3. The FluidAudio Core ML files above are not used on Intel. Managed local AI cleanup models are unavailable in the Intel source build.

To check a file's SHA256 on a Mac, run `shasum -a 256` followed by the file path in Terminal.

Install or restore the files

1. **Quit Whisperstream from its tray menu,** or its menu bar icon on a Mac. Closing its window only hides the app. Wait for any model download to stop before copying files.
2. **Obtain the matching files.** Use your backup, the pinned source linked in the model's section, or the listed upstream archive. You can download on another computer and transfer the files using an external drive.
3. **Extract archives before copying.** Copy the required files into the exact destination below. Preserve Qwen's `tokenizer` subfolder. Avoid adding an extra archive-named folder between the destination and the files.
4. **Check the files.** Compare their sizes and SHA256 checksums with the reference at the end of this guide. Verify every manual copy, including files recovered from an interrupted download.
5. **Start Whisperstream.** Choose the corresponding language and speech model, or complete Local enhancement setup for the cleanup model you restored.

For a new offline installation, install the app, leave it closed, and place the files before first launch. During onboarding, choose a language supported by the speech model you copied. Automatic selection expects Parakeet v2 for English, Parakeet v3 for its other supported languages, or Qwen for languages outside Parakeet's range. If you intend to use Cohere, finish language setup with the recommended model available, then choose Cohere on Home.

Whisperstream checks the expected filenames in its model folders. It reuses existing nonempty files and downloads missing or empty files when you request a model. It does not search Downloads, scan arbitrary folders, or import an archive you select. Its automatic GitHub backup unpacks only the approved archive through the verified downloader.

A file being detected does not prove it is complete. Existing files are not fully rehashed during ordinary detection. An interrupted file can be nonempty and still fail to load. If that happens, quit the app and replace the affected file with a verified copy. Do not replace a working model merely to fix an unrelated failed download.

NVIDIA Parakeet v2: English dictation

NVIDIA Parakeet TDT 0.6B v2, converted for sherpa-onnx with INT8 ONNX encoder, decoder and joiner.

Destination folder

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\models\nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v2-int8\
```

Required files

```
encoder.int8.onnx
decoder.int8.onnx
joiner.int8.onnx
tokens.txt
```

Pinned source: csukuangfj/sherpa-onnx-nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v2-int8

Revision: `1ab9323565ddb038682214b292f588070a538ce2`

Automatic backup and manual recovery source: sherpa-onnx-nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v2-int8.tar.bz2 on the sherpa-onnx GitHub release. Check the extracted required files against the checksums below before using them.

Use it: On Home, choose English. Automatic selection uses this exact v2 model.

NVIDIA Parakeet v3: multilingual dictation

NVIDIA Parakeet TDT 0.6B v3, converted for sherpa-onnx with INT8 ONNX encoder, decoder and joiner. It supports 25 languages, including English.

Destination folder

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\models\nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v3-int8\
```

Required files

```
encoder.int8.onnx
decoder.int8.onnx
joiner.int8.onnx
tokens.txt
```

Pinned source: csukuangfj/sherpa-onnx-nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v3-int8

Revision: `2bda32ec70b097a55adaa07d9a7173915b43cc78`

Automatic backup and manual recovery source: sherpa-onnx-nemo-parakeet-tdt-0.6b-v3-int8.tar.bz2 on the sherpa-onnx GitHub release. Check the extracted required files against the checksums below before using them.

Use it: On Home, choose a supported non-English language. Automatic selection uses v3 for those languages. A new English setup expects v2; copying v3 alone does not satisfy that v2 download check.

Qwen3-ASR: multilingual dictation

Qwen3-ASR 0.6B, using the sherpa-onnx INT8 export dated 2026-03-25. This is the speech-recognition model, not a Qwen text-generation model.

Destination folder

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\models\qwen3-asr-0.6b-int8\
```

Required files

```
conv_frontend.onnx
encoder.int8.onnx
decoder.int8.onnx
tokenizer/vocab.json
tokenizer/merges.txt
tokenizer/tokenizer_config.json
```

Keep the three tokenizer files inside `tokenizer`. Do not flatten that subfolder or substitute the older export from a different repository.

Pinned source: csukuangfj2/sherpa-onnx-qwen3-asr-0.6B-int8-2026-03-25

Revision: `68818b2313fe77bd06f6a7c5068ff3ef59d02b8a`

Automatic backup and manual recovery source: sherpa-onnx-qwen3-asr-0.6B-int8-2026-03-25.tar.bz2 on the sherpa-onnx GitHub release. Check the extracted required files against the checksums below before using them.

Use it: On Home, choose a supported language. Automatic selection uses Qwen when Parakeet does not support that language. To use Qwen for another compatible language, open Advanced, turn on Choose speech model manually, and choose Qwen3 ASR.

Cohere Transcribe: optional dictation model

Cohere Transcribe, using the sherpa-onnx 14-language INT8 ONNX export dated 2026-04-01.

Destination folder

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\models\cohere-transcribe-03-2026-int8\
```

Required files

```
encoder.int8.onnx
encoder.int8.onnx.data
decoder.int8.onnx
tokens.txt
```

Keep `encoder.int8.onnx.data` beside `encoder.int8.onnx`. The `.data` file contains most of the encoder weights and is required. The local folder name contains `03-2026`, even though the export source is dated `2026-04-01`. Use the destination shown above.

Pinned source: csukuangfj2/sherpa-onnx-cohere-transcribe-14-lang-int8-2026-04-01

Revision: `156a470cf08eefe706a0004f3c52d9ee567ca7a0`

Automatic backup and manual recovery source: sherpa-onnx-cohere-transcribe-14-lang-int8-2026-04-01.tar.bz2 on the sherpa-onnx GitHub release. Check the extracted required files against the checksums below before using them.

Use it: On Home, choose a supported Dictation Language, then select Cohere Transcribe in the model picker. This enters Manual selection. Cohere uses the selected language for recognition. Automatic selection does not choose Cohere.

Gemma 4 E2B: Customizable local enhancement

Google Gemma 4 E2B Instruct (the E2B-it model), using Unsloth's Q4_K_M GGUF. Whisperstream calls it Customizable in the Local model picker.

Destination folder

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\local-llm\
```

Required files

```
gemma-4-E2B-it-Q4_K_M.gguf
```

Download the single `Q4_K_M` file listed above. Whisperstream uses this model for text only, so no vision projector (`mmproj`) file is needed. Its runtime and chat template come with the app.

Pinned source: unsloth/gemma-4-E2B-it-GGUF

Revision: `0314792d7f1f7e229411f620751375812bb9faf2`

Use it: Open Enhancement, choose Local, and run the speed check for Customizable (Gemma 4 E2B). This file is for text cleanup; it does not replace a speech-recognition model.

Gemma 4 E2B QAT: automatic Google backup

Google's official Gemma 4 E2B Instruct QAT Q4_0 GGUF is the automatic backup for Customizable when its primary source is unavailable. Its weights, size and checksum differ from Unsloth's Q4_K_M file above, and results may differ. Both appear as the same Customizable choice in the app.

Destination folder

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\local-llm\
```

Required files

```
gemma-4-E2B_q4_0-it.gguf
```

Keep this exact filename. Do not rename it to the Unsloth model's filename or overwrite that model. No vision projector (`mmproj`) file is needed for text cleanup; the app supplies the runtime and chat template.

Pinned source: google/gemma-4-E2B-it-qat-q4_0-gguf

Revision: `675cff42a74c774d6cb76f76d8eacb49b48c9b93`

Use it: Open Enhancement, choose Local, and run the speed check for **Customizable**. The app checks the Gemma artifact it will use; a result for the other artifact does not qualify this file. An automatic Google fallback remembers that file. If no saved artifact choice exists and both files are present, the app prefers Unsloth. If only one supported file is present, it uses that file. Keep the file you intend to use and verify its checksum; do not overwrite or rename a working model to force a different variant.

Stream-1 Mini: local enhancement

Whisperstream's own dictation cleanup model, fine-tuned from Qwen3-0.6B-Base. It is the default local enhancement model.

Destination folder

```
%LOCALAPPDATA%\Whisperstream\local-llm\
```

Required files

```
stream-1-mini-vocabulary-q4_k_m.gguf
```

Keep the exact filename, including lowercase `q4_k_m`. The vocabulary revision has a distinct filename so an older E model is not reused with new prompts. Do not rename an older Mini file to this name. Plain Qwen3-0.6B is not Stream-1 Mini. Whisperstream supplies the model's built-in cleanup prompts and settings.

Pinned source: whisperstream/stream-1-mini

Revision: `ee30dd90bd346d781d0e420d3c6c23244798e7b9`

Use it: Open Enhancement and choose Local. The speed check runs for Stream-1 Mini. It supports English Chat and Email cleanup. It does not provide speech recognition or Code-profile enhancement.

If a model link stops working

Try these options in order:

1. **Restore your own backup.** A verified copy from a working installation is sufficient. You do not need to register its download with Whisperstream.

2. **Look for the exact export or filename.** The repository names, revisions and file lists above identify the expected artifacts even if the original page moves. For speech models, the linked sherpa-onnx release archives provide another place to look.
3. **Verify a mirror against this guide.** Matching SHA256 values establish that the required files are the same bytes as the supported payload. Keep accompanying model licenses and notices with your backup.

A similar model name is not enough. A PyTorch or Safetensors download cannot replace an ONNX bundle or GGUF file. FP16, another quantization, a different model size, a different ONNX conversion, or a newer revision may require app changes. Renaming those files does not make them compatible.

If the exact payload is unavailable, choose another supported model for your language. If only enhancement is affected, leave AI Enhancement off and continue using ordinary dictation. Whisperstream's built-in download links cannot be changed in Settings; manually copying the supported files avoids relying on those links.

Use one local enhancement model

Stream-1 Mini and Customizable can each be set up alone. Customizable needs one of the supported Gemma files, not both.

1. Copy the GGUF file for the model you want into `local-llm`.
2. Restart Whisperstream and open **Enhancement**.
3. Choose **Local**. Turning on local cleanup checks Stream-1 Mini. To use Customizable instead, choose **Customizable** in the model picker; Whisperstream checks only that model.
4. Select **Start speed check**. Whisperstream reuses the file you copied and checks that model on your computer. It does not download the other model.
5. Follow the result to select the model. A passing result lets you use it. A slow-but-usable result requires **Use it anyway**. A model that is too slow has no override.

Each model needs its own speed check on the computer where you will use it. Restoring a GGUF file does not transfer another computer's performance result. A failed download does not mean your computer is too slow, and one model's result does not qualify the other.

The app supplies the local `llama-server` engine. If the engine itself is missing or damaged, restore or reinstall the official app. Copying more GGUF files will not repair it. If local cleanup cannot run, turn off **AI Enhancement** to keep dictating with your installed speech model.

Troubleshoot a restored model

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO CHECK
Whisperstream still offers a download	Confirm the selected model and version, the model-storage base, exact folder name, and every required file. A v3 folder does not satisfy a v2 selection. Restart after copying files.
A model is detected but will not load	Check the SHA256 values. The files may be incomplete, from different exports, or the wrong format.
Cohere will not load	Check that the large `encoder.int8.onnx.data` file is present beside its ONNX file.
Qwen will not load	Check `conv_frontend.onnx` and all three files under `tokenizer`.
Files are unexpectedly tiny	Check that you downloaded the actual weights, not a Git LFS pointer, web page, or shortcut.
Local cleanup tries to download an unwanted model	Cancel and start a speed check for only the model you have installed.
Recognition uses the wrong language	Check Dictation Language. Cohere requires the chosen language; keep each recording to one language.
Dictation works but cleanup does not	Speech recognition and enhancement use different models. Verify the GGUF location and complete that cleanup model's speed check.

Verify downloaded files

Windows PowerShell can calculate SHA256 without installing another tool. For example, to check Stream-1 Mini in the default location:

```
Get-FileHash -Algorithm SHA256 -LiteralPath "$env:LOCALAPPDATA\Whisperstream\local-llm\stream-1-mini-vocabulary-q4_k_m.gguf"
```

Compare the returned `Hash` with the reference below. Uppercase and lowercase letters mean the same thing. Substitute the actual file path when checking another model or a custom storage location. Hashing a large file can take a little time.

The byte sizes below help spot an incomplete download, but matching size alone is not verification. The checksums apply to each extracted file, not to a containing ZIP or tar archive.

Checksums: NVIDIA Parakeet v2

`encoder.int8.onnx` (652,184,296 bytes)

```
a32b12d17bbbc309d0686fbbcc2987b5e9b8333a7da83fa6b089f0a2acd651ab
```

`decoder.int8.onnx` (7,257,753 bytes)

```
b6bb64963457237b900e496ee9994b59294526439fbcc1fecf705b31a15c6b4e
```

`joiner.int8.onnx` (1,739,080 bytes)

```
7946164367946e7f9f29a122407c3252b680dbae9a51343eb2488d057c3c43d2
```

`tokens.txt` (9,384 bytes)

```
ec182b70dd42113aff6c5372c75cac58c952443eb22322f57bbd7f53977d497d
```

Checksums: NVIDIA Parakeet v3

`encoder.int8.onnx` (652,184,281 bytes)

```
acfc2b4456377e15d04f0243af540b7fe7c992f8d898d751cf134c3a55fd2247
```

`decoder.int8.onnx` (11,845,275 bytes)

```
179e50c43d1a9de79c8a24149a2f9bac6eb5981823f2a2ed88d655b24248db4e
```

`joiner.int8.onnx` (6,355,277 bytes)

```
3164c13fc2821009440d20fcb5fdc78bff28b4db2f8d0f0b329101719c0948b3
```

`tokens.txt` (93,939 bytes)

```
d58544679ea4bc6ac563d1f545eb7d474bd6cfa467f0a6e2c1dc1c7d37e3c35d
```

Checksums: Qwen3-ASR

`conv_frontend.onnx` (44,148,281 bytes)

```
d22dc4423e0940e49884e903d2ea2f7e5567c14fc1aed97e4e26d6b8f208ef9e
```

`encoder.int8.onnx` (182,491,662 bytes)

```
60748d3e6744a57c9c91e1b17424a6c2990567e8adceb0783940c03ed98fa9d9
```

`decoder.int8.onnx` (755,914,231 bytes)

```
4f6885be5959ae26af3089d38ee7972c5fafbeeb1cf8d5e76eab6d8b61ca5771
```

`tokenizer/vocab.json` (2,776,833 bytes)

```
ca10d7e9fb3ed18575dd1e277a2579c16d108e32f27439684afa0e10b1440910
```

`tokenizer/merges.txt` (1,671,853 bytes)

```
8831e4f1a044471340f7c0a83d7bd71306a5b867e95fd870f74d0c5308a904d5
```

`tokenizer/tokenizer_config.json` (12,487 bytes)

```
4942d005604266809309cabc9f4e9cb89ce855d59b14681fdc0e1cc62ea26c4c
```

Checksums: Cohere Transcribe

`encoder.int8.onnx` (3,090,822 bytes)

```
cf704f8cfa90e3f0a76f9ffc05998bdf00ba9ae983192c14a85a3a5eb008b367
```

`encoder.int8.onnx.data` (2,731,503,072 bytes)

```
bcf1b7148c8518ae52df1ad2d2fc2b4e89261ea23e6c874eef1d9f55bcbaa4a3
```

`decoder.int8.onnx` (153,250,705 bytes)

```
8372ca6c8ff4db8b916ca3592f5c757a715e691b9edec751ba19b29fc854baf9
```

`tokens.txt` (207,437 bytes)

```
013ede043ae2480e3a9205cc34550d9686100cc682bacc90f702facdfbb93035
```

Checksums: Gemma 4 E2B

`gemma-4-E2B-it-Q4_K_M.gguf` (3,106,738,272 bytes)

```
740185b21d22ceb83a11c3aa62ad5842ef32c70f6096d756bbee85a1e4ec34b8
```

Checksums: Gemma 4 E2B QAT (Google)

`gemma-4-E2B_q4_0-it.gguf` (3,349,516,256 bytes)

```
fa401b55b07ee70a54c6dae3903c783a6e65064312529ea57175cb5f8dec6634
```

Checksums: Stream-1 Mini

`stream-1-mini-vocabulary-q4_k_m.gguf` (484,215,648 bytes)

```
32bef61bdbc98787ac278d96a2aad120a9fc61f588f1f0a4746441e9d6d89ae7
```

Keep a recovery backup

After a successful setup, quit Whisperstream and copy the model folders you use to an external drive. Keep them with your installer or source revision, build instructions and this documentation. Back up both `models` and `local-llm` if you use local cleanup. On a new computer, restore the files to that computer's model-storage location and complete its own setup and enhancement speed check.